Anupam Chugh

Product-minded Engineer | iOS and Android | Apps with On-device AI
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SUMMARY

BITS Pilani computer science graduate with 10+ years building consumer apps on iOS and Android. I took over and steadied a struggling Android team at Agricx, built customer and driver delivery apps alongside product, web and support teams at MOBEY, and took over Better Programming from my predecessor, then consolidated and grew it into Medium's largest programming publication. Since 2024 I run Alcor, an independent Apple studio with 19 apps on the App Store, several of them built on on-device AI.

SKILLS

Mobile: Swift, SwiftUI, UIKit, Kotlin, Java, Android, SwiftData, CloudKit, MapKit, AVFoundation, RealityKit, App Intents.
AI and vision: Apple Foundation Models, Core ML, Vision, OpenCV, model evaluation, MCP, agent-assisted development.
Quality: XCTest, Swift Testing, UI test automation, simulator screenshot pipelines, App Store release checks.
Leadership: Team mentoring, codebase turnarounds, cross-functional work with product, web, ML and support, editorial strategy.
Product: Prototyping, interface design, release planning, App Store delivery.

EXPERIENCE

Independent Product Builder | Alcor (getalcor.com) 2024–present

- After Better Programming I went back to building, one everyday question at a time: 19 apps now live across iPhone, iPad, Mac and Apple Watch, each taken from idea to release myself.
- **Wearover** (iPhone, iPad, Mac): it began as Best Face Forward, which found your best face in a Live Photo, and grew into a restyler. Change the outfit in a photo or restyle a room, while your face and your space stay yours. Meta's Muse Image now does photo edits inside WhatsApp in the cloud; Wearover does it on the phone, privately.
- **Breakline:** I started it while a surfing injury kept me out of the water. It reads your pose from your own surf and gym clips and shows how you move, frame by frame: measurements, never a score, nothing uploaded. The next release replays your move on a 3D humanoid version of you.
- **Orbits:** every group dinner started with twenty minutes of "where should we eat?" Orbits skips to the answer: everyone swipes, and the plan is what you all liked. Shipped in February 2026, nine months before WhatsApp launched Events Home.
- **TradeShot, Glint and TickNote** (in development): I want trading to make sense without a finance degree. They explain the market in plain words, let you practise with paper trades and games like Flickpot, and suggest trades based on your own goals. Nothing is ever traded without your say.
- **The editor's habit never left:** Threadmark traces a person, project or link across the web and keeps every finding with its source; Landfall turns your work story into a résumé where every line traces back to your own words; DocPolish cleans up passports, IDs and receipts without them leaving the phone.
- **Board-game nights became apps:** Flickpot, a coin-flicking game on green felt where every coin is a market ticker (also on Apple Watch), and Checkmate Academy for learning chess. Feedloom keeps the feeds and writers I follow in one calm place.

Managing Editor | Better Programming, Medium 2021–2023

- Took over Better Programming from my predecessor, then consolidated and grew it into Medium's largest programming publication: lifetime pageviews rose from 50M to 150M, peaking near 6M a month, across 4,600 authors. Medium put the publication on hiatus after I left.
- Scouted, mentored and edited engineers who code across the globe, from a 10-year-old writer to people in their 70s learning Java.
- Built MediumRSS, a feed hunter across 100+ Medium topics, to spot writers early and follow their trajectory, not just their latest post. Coffee Bytes grew out of it: a newsletter that put the writers and stories it found in front of readers.
- Squashed weak submissions and kept the strong ones, improving and extending the review tools built by my predecessor, Zack Shapiro.

Mobile Developer (Contract) | Aged Care Decisions, Australia (remote) 2020–2021

- Built server-driven, white-labelled iOS and Android apps for Australia's largest aged care placement service: one codebase, several vendor apps the web team could ship.

Android Team Lead and iOS Developer | Agricx 2018–2019

- Took over a messy Android codebase and team, and left both in better shape by the end: cleaner code, steadier releases and engineers I mentored along the way.
- Taught myself iOS for its fluid animations, then built the company's entire iOS app end to end, through to TestFlight: count, size and grade a crop sample with OpenCV, ArUco markers and AVFoundation (gallery).
- Worked with a strong ML team and web team; moved early experiments onto the device with Core ML while their models were being fine-tuned.

Lead Android Developer | MOBEY 2015–2017

- Built the customer and driver Android apps for on-demand delivery of food, groceries and alcohol on the Gold Coast, working daily with product managers, web developers and customer support (gallery).
- Covered the order-to-delivery journey: driver go-online, receipt capture, proof of delivery and tipping; helped redesign the iOS apps.
- When Uber sent a legal notice over the original name, MUBER, a week before launch, rebranded the entire Android app in days.
- Shipped the very last iOS update before the company shut down in 2017: a one-line display text change, so the final word in the app was mine.

Android Developer and Technical Writer | JournalDev 2015–2018

- Built the first JournalDev Android app (4.4 stars, 10K+ downloads) and wrote Android, Java and Kotlin tutorials; JournalDev was later acquired by DigitalOcean (gallery).

Co-founder | Dourier 2015

- Built a courier and print-delivery MVP with friends to learn how a startup breaks before joining one. Shipped it, learned what we needed, and let it go.

Software Engineering Intern | Syniverse 2014

- Integrated a Spring Batch application into the team's financial clearing product; offered a pre-placement job and turned it down to build my own apps.

EDUCATION

Birla Institute of Technology and Science (BITS Pilani), Hyderabad Campus 2011–2015

B.E., Computer Science

OPEN SOURCE AND TOOLS

- **ChughyFMStack:** my shared Swift package for on-device AI. One feature runs the same on iPhone, Mac, the Simulator and previews, and falls back to simple rules when the model is not available. Powers several Alcor apps.
- **Deckloom:** a SwiftUI package for cards you can stack, swipe, fan out like a hand or open full screen, with no dependencies.
- **SimLanes:** keeps testing honest across many apps by proving the right app is running before any screenshot is trusted.
- **chughy-skills:** safety checks a coding assistant runs before an App Store upload, such as blocking hidden switches left in a release.
- **Pastport:** ask your Safari history in plain words to find a page again or spot the ideas you keep coming back to. Runs privately on your Mac.
- **iowncode:** 900+ GitHub stars. Years of iOS, Core ML, Vision and AR experiments with tutorials, including a card stack you swipe with a thumbs-up instead of a finger.

WRITING

- Wrote for engineers in three voices: tutorials (iOSDevie), analysis (The Big Tech) and satire (Humor Bytes). "Apple Is Killing a Billion Dollar Industry" passed 500K views and reached the Hacker News front page.

HOW I BUILD

- I think about user flows like film scenes: setup, tension, payoff.
- I keep my own copy: if you don't own the ground, you're decorating someone else's house.
- I build curious things until one becomes useful. The hand-gesture card stack from 2020 became the swipe in Orbits.